was immediately sanctioned. Col Moti Singh was, and still is, a large-hearted person, full of life, and there was never a dull moment when he was around. With my main worry out of the way, I could properly concentrate on my job as the training officer-cum-staff officer to the CO. My job as the training officer was to implement the training programme made by the GSO-1 (Training) at the Centre HQ, ensuring that the training Platoons reached their appointed classes as per the schedule, lesson plans were updated and followed, training aids were available in adequate numbers, etc. Whenever there was firing planned at the long range, I would be there the whole day, it being mandatory for an officer to be present at all times. On other days, I would go around the various training areas—the field craft/battle craft to the weapons training or the drill square to keep an eye on the training. It was fine in winters, but doing so in the summer months with strong, dusty, gusty, hot and dry summer winds and hot breeze—the famous north Indian 'loo'—was torture. Training would start in the early hours of the morning and end by about 1130 hours as a precaution against heat stroke. Those were simple and carefree days, teaching the fresh young recruits how to march and hold a rifle, demonstrating various firing positions and how to crawl undetected from cover to cover—the various small things I had learnt as a cadet at the NDA and IMA. Each day, I would come back with a quiet sense of satisfaction of having done my job.

As sanctioned, I proceeded on leave to Delhi and our daughter, Isha, was born on 23 March 1987. I was there to drive Veena to the hospital, New Delhi Nursing Home in Green Park, not far from our house in Safdarjung Enclave. We had selected this hospital because that's where my sister-in-law Anita (Nitin's wife) had her baby, and the doctor, Urmil Sharma, was known to her. I'm sure every parent experiences the same

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